are essential. For instance, IOs may store sensitive information physically in highly restricted archives or rely on fortified online systems to safeguard data. Access to such information must be tightly controlled, with clearance granted only to select staff. Additionally, IOs may need to collaborate with specialized firms to acquire cutting-edge security tools or build their own internal capacities to manage sensitive information effectively.

While technological advancements have made many security tools more accessible and cost-effective, IOs must remain vigilant against risks such as leaks or cyberattacks. Ensuring the trust of member states means implementing rigorous security measures that minimize vulnerabilities and protect the integrity of confidential interactions. Failure to do so risks undermining confidence in these mechanisms, which could deter states from fully utilizing them.

By investing in the infrastructure and protocols necessary for private engagement, IOs can provide a secure forum for dialogue that accommodates the needs of populist leaders and skeptical governments. This approach not only preserves trust but also ensures that even contentious states can contribute meaningfully to the global governance process, shielding these interactions from potentially damaging public scrutiny while promoting collaboration behind the scenes.

9.1.4 Preemptive Appeasement of Constituents

IOs can actively work to shape favorable public opinion, reducing the support that populists can rally against them during campaigns or while in office. Populist leaders often gain traction by opposing IOs, framing them as symbols of elitism and threats to national sovereignty. However, if the general public views these organizations positively, populist attacks on multilateralism lose their appeal and can even backfire, sparking domestic backlash against leaders who denounce international cooperation.

To build public support, IOs must prioritize consistent and effective communication with domestic audiences. This involves leveraging media outreach, forming partnerships with local businesses and civil society groups, and crafting effective social media campaigns. By promoting their successes and showcasing the tangible benefits they deliver, IOs can connect with everyday citizens and counter perceptions of being distant or